```
    include /etc/nginx/sites-enabled/*;
}
```

We now need to create two directories inside */etc/nginx/*, namely sites-available and sites-enabled, as follows:

```
root@server_1 # mkdir /etc/nginx/sites-available /etc/nginx/sites-enabled
```

Let's now create a new file */etc/nginx/sites-available/default* with the following data:

```
server {
    listen 8001;
    server_name server_1.unixclinic.net;
    access_log /var/log/nginx/server_1.unixclinic.net-access.log;
    error_log /var/log/nginx/server1.unixclinic.net-error.log;

    location / {
        root /var/www;
        index index.html index.htm index.php;
    }
}
```

Subsequent to this, execute the following commands:

```
root@server_1 # cd /etc/nginx/sites-enabled
root@server_1 # ln -s ../sites-available/default
```

Now let us create a simple "Hello World!" HTML file in the document root:

```
root@server_1 # echo "Hello World!" >/var/www/index.html
```

Before getting started, we need to test the *nginx* configuration, and only then start it:

```
root@server_1 # nginx -t
root@server_1 # invoke-rc.d nginx start
```

By accessing the website from the browser by visiting *http://server_1.unixclinic.net* we can verify that the Web server is working fine.

Adding PHP support to *nginx*

Of course, the first step is to install *php5-cgi* packages:

```
root@server_1 # apt-get install php5-common php5-cgi
```

nginx does not have in-built support for *fastcgi* processes unlike Apache and *lighttpd*, and so we have to take charge for managing *fastcgi* processes.

As recommended on the *nginx* wiki, I would like to use the *lighttpd*'s *spawn-fcgi* program for *php5-fastcgi* implementation. There are loads of other possibilities that you can check by visiting the URLs mentioned in the resources section at the end of this article.

To get *spawn-fcgi*, I downloaded the latest stable *lighttpd* and compiled it. Once the compilation was done and I had the script, I removed all the build tools.

```
root@server_1 # apt-get install build-essential libpcre3-dev zlib1g-dev
root@server_1 # cd /root
root@server_1 # wget http://www.lighttpd.net/download/lighttpd-1.4.19.tar.gz
root@server_1 # tar -xvzf lighttpd-1.4.19.tar.gz
root@server_1 # cd lighttpd-1.4.19
root@server_1 # ./configure
root@server_1 # make
root@server_1 # cp src/spawn-fcgi /usr/local/bin
```

Now let us remove what we have installed for building the *lighttpd*.

```
root@server_1 # dpkg --purge libpcre3-dev libpcrecpp0 \
build-essential cpp cpp-4.1 g++ g++-4.1 gcc gcc-4.1 \
libc6-dev libssp0 libstdc++6-4.1-dev linux-kernel-headers \
zlib1g-dev libbz2-dev root@server_1 # rm -rf /root/lighttpd-1.4.19
```

We can start the *fast-cgi* server as follows:

```
root@server_1 # /usr/bin/spawn-fcgi -a 127.0.0.1 \
-p 9000 -u www-data -f /usr/bin/php5-cgi
```

This can be verified by:

```
root@server_1 # ps axu|grep php
```

To start the *fastcgi* server after every reboot, we can put the following line in */etc/rc.local* file, or as suggested on the *nginx* wiki, we can write a custom script also. I have chosen to take the ancient route of */etc/rc.local* file:

```
/usr/bin/spawn-fcgi -a 127.0.0.1 -p 9000 -u www-data -f /usr/bin/php5-cgi
exit 0
```

Now, to configure *nginx* to pass all incoming requests for PHP files to the *fastcgi* process listening on port 9000, we need to add the following location directive to */etc/nginx/sites-available/default* file. This line needs to be added before the closing of the server directive:

```
location ~ \.php$ {
    include /etc/nginx/fastcgi_params;
    fastcgi_pass 127.0.0.1:9000;
    fastcgi_index index.php;
    fastcgi_param SCRIPT_FILENAME /var/www$fastcgi_script_name;
}
```

Finally, let us create a simple PHP script in the document root to test this. The traditional route is to create a *phpinfo()* script, but I will just create a "Hello World!" script for security reasons. Open the */var/www/*